

ZHOUDAN (ZOEY) XIE

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U.S. Citizen

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, The George Washington University, Washington DC	May 2025
M.P.P., Public Policy, The George Washington University, Washington DC	August 2016
M.A., Environmental Governance, Keio University, Japan	September 2012
B.A., Japanese & International Trade, Nanjing University of Aeronautics and Astronautics, China	June 2010

RECENT POSITIONS

Public Company Accounting Oversight Board (PCAOB)	Washington DC
<i>Financial Economist (Full Time)</i>	June 2025 - Present

- Conduct prospective economic analyses to assess the potential benefits and costs of auditing regulations and collaborate across offices and divisions to develop regulatory impact analyses supporting rulemaking.
- Conduct retrospective economic analyses to evaluate the post-implementation effects of auditing regulations and prepare staff white papers communicating findings.
- Review and synthesize academic literature on the effects of audit regulation on capital markets, technology adoption and innovation in auditing, and corporate management and finance.
- Analyze and visualize large-scale financial market and audit engagement data using Python and R in Databricks.
- Design survey instruments to collect qualitative and quantitative data from regulated entities and other stakeholders.

The George Washington University Regulatory Studies Center	Washington DC
<i>Senior Policy Analyst (Full Time)</i>	October 2017 – June 2025

- Led independent and collaborative research on how U.S. regulations affect innovation, firm dynamics, economic growth, and other economic outcomes using theoretical models, econometric methods, NLP, and large-scale regulatory, patent, firm-level, and macroeconomic data.
- Collaborated with interdisciplinary scholars on peer-reviewed journal articles and applied policy research on regulatory impact analysis, bureaucratic behavior, and public participation in rulemaking.
- Designed automated pipelines to collect, structure, visualize, and analyze large-scale regulatory data from government websites, APIs, and bulk repositories using Python and R.
- Developed and maintained organizational databases on [Github](#), [dashboards](#), [websites](#), and other data products.
- Supervised and mentored student research assistants and junior research staff, supporting skill development, research execution, and professional growth.

The World Bank	Washington DC
<i>Research Consultant (Part Time)</i>	November 2016 – June 2017

- Conducted econometric analyses in Stata using OLS, 2SLS, and GMM to examine the relationship between financial system development and economic growth in European countries.
- Conducted literature reviews, data collection and cleaning, and quantitative analyses of technological change, employment, skill demand, and productivity using data from 170+ countries since 1980.
- Prepared conference presentations and provided research support to senior economists.

WORKING PAPERS

“[Regulation-Driven Innovations: A Textual Analysis of U.S. Patents and Federal Regulations](#),” R&R at *Review of Economic Dynamics*.

PUBLICATIONS

- “[Sentiment and Uncertainty about Regulation](#),” with Tara M. Sinclair, forthcoming at *Macroeconomic Dynamics*.
- “[The Economic Impact of Uncertainty about U.S. Regulations of the Energy Sector](#),” with Xiaohan Ma, *Economic Inquiry*, Vol 63, Issue 3, pp. 985-1002 (2025).
- “[Comparing the Draft and Final Circular A-4](#),” with Mark Febrizio and Sarah Hay, *Journal of Benefit-Cost Analysis*, Vol 16, Issue S2, pp. 315-325 (2025).
- “[Regulatory Impact Analysis and Litigation Risk](#),” with Christopher Carrigan and Jerry Ellig, *Journal of Benefit-Cost Analysis*, Vol 16, Issue S1, pp. 3-21 (2025).
- “[Notice the Comment? Chinese Government Responsiveness to Public Participation in the Policymaking Process](#),” with Steven J. Balla, Andrew Wan, Yat To Yeung and Geng Zhai, *Governance*, Vol 38, Issue 2 (2025).
- “[The Durability of Governance Reform: A Two-Wave Audit of Notice and Comment Policymaking in China](#),” with Steven J. Balla, *Regulation & Governance*, Vol 17, Issue 2, pp. 549-569 (2023).
- “[Nudging the Nudger: Toward a Choice Architecture for Regulators](#),” with Susan E. Dudley, *Regulation & Governance*, Vol 16, Issue 1, pp. 261-273 (2022).
- “[Online Consultation and the Institutionalization of Transparency and Participation in Chinese Policymaking](#),” with Steven J. Balla, *The China Quarterly*, Vol 246, pp. 473-496 (2021).
- “[Consultation as Policymaking Innovation: Comparing Government Transparency and Public Participation in China and the United States](#),” with Steven J. Balla, *Journal of Chinese Governance*, Vol 5, Issue 4, pp. 525-545 (2020).
- “[Designing a Choice Architecture for Regulators](#),” with Susan E. Dudley, *Public Administration Review*, Vol 80, Issue 1, pp. 151-156 (2019).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026: American Economic Association 2026 Annual Meeting Poster Session.
- 2025: The Metrics of Regulation webinar ([recording](#)); Society for Benefit-Cost Analysis 2025 Annual Conference.
- 2024: Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting; GW Macro-International Seminar.
- 2022: Conference on Real-Time Data Analysis, Methods, and Applications ([recording](#)); Jerry Ellig Memorial Conference.
- 2021: Southern Economic Association 91st Annual Meeting; Pennsylvania State University Macro Seminar; ESCoE Conference on Economic Measurement ([recording](#)); Federal Forecasters Conference; Forecasting Seminar of GW's H. O. Stekler Research Program on Forecasting.
- 2020: Southern Economic Association 90th Annual Meeting; 2020 Banca d'Italia and Federal Reserve Board Joint Conference on Nontraditional Data & Statistical Learning with Applications to Macroeconomics ([recording](#)); Law and Society Association 2020 Annual Meeting.
- 2019: Southern Economic Association 89th Annual Meeting; American Political Science Association 115th Annual Meeting; Law and Society Association 2019 Annual Meeting; Midwest Political Science Association 77th Annual Meeting; Society for Benefit-Cost Analysis 11th Annual Conference.
- 2018: Southern Economic Association 88th Annual Meeting; Public Administration Review Symposium on Behavioral Approaches to Bureaucratic Red Tape and Administration Burden; Society for Benefit-Cost Analysis 10th Annual Conference.

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, GW Regulatory Studies Center

November 2015 – October 2017

Policy Coordination Intern, United Nations Environment Programme, New York NY
Global Programs Intern, Vital Voices Global Partnership, Washington DC
Research Intern, International Fund for China's Environment, Washington DC

April – July 2015
February – April 2015
October – December 2014

AWARDS, GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Lead Researcher, U.S. Department of Agriculture & GW Regulatory Studies Center Cooperative Agreements	2016, 2018, 2019
Japanese Government (MEXT) Scholarship for Research Student	2010 – 2012
Taikichiro Mori Memorial Research Grant, Keio University	2012
China National Scholarship	2007

SERVICE

Journal Referee: *International Public Management Journal*; *Journal of Politics*; *Public Choice*; *Public Performance & Management Review*; *Public Policy and Administration*; *Regulation & Governance*.

Student Member, H.O. Stekler Research Program on Forecasting, 2020-2025.

OTHER TRAININGS

Graduate Certificate in Data Science, The George Washington University	August 2020
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SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning, Website Design
Programming: Python, R, Stata, LaTeX, JavaScript, HTML, CSS
Chinese (native proficiency) and Japanese (full professional proficiency).

CITIZENSHIP

U.S. Citizen

REFERENCES

Tara Sinclair (Committee Chair)
Department Chair; Professor of Economics and
International Affairs
Department of Economics
The George Washington University
tsinc@gwu.edu

Leah Brooks (Committee Member)
Professor of Public Policy and Public Administration
Trachtenberg School of Public Policy and Public
Administration
The George Washington University
lfbrooks@gwu.edu

Roberto Samaniego (Committee Member)
Professor of Economics and International Affairs
Department of Economics
The George Washington University
roberto@gwu.edu

Susan Dudley (Work Supervisor)
Senior Scholar & Founder
Regulatory Studies Center
The George Washington University
sdudley@gwu.edu